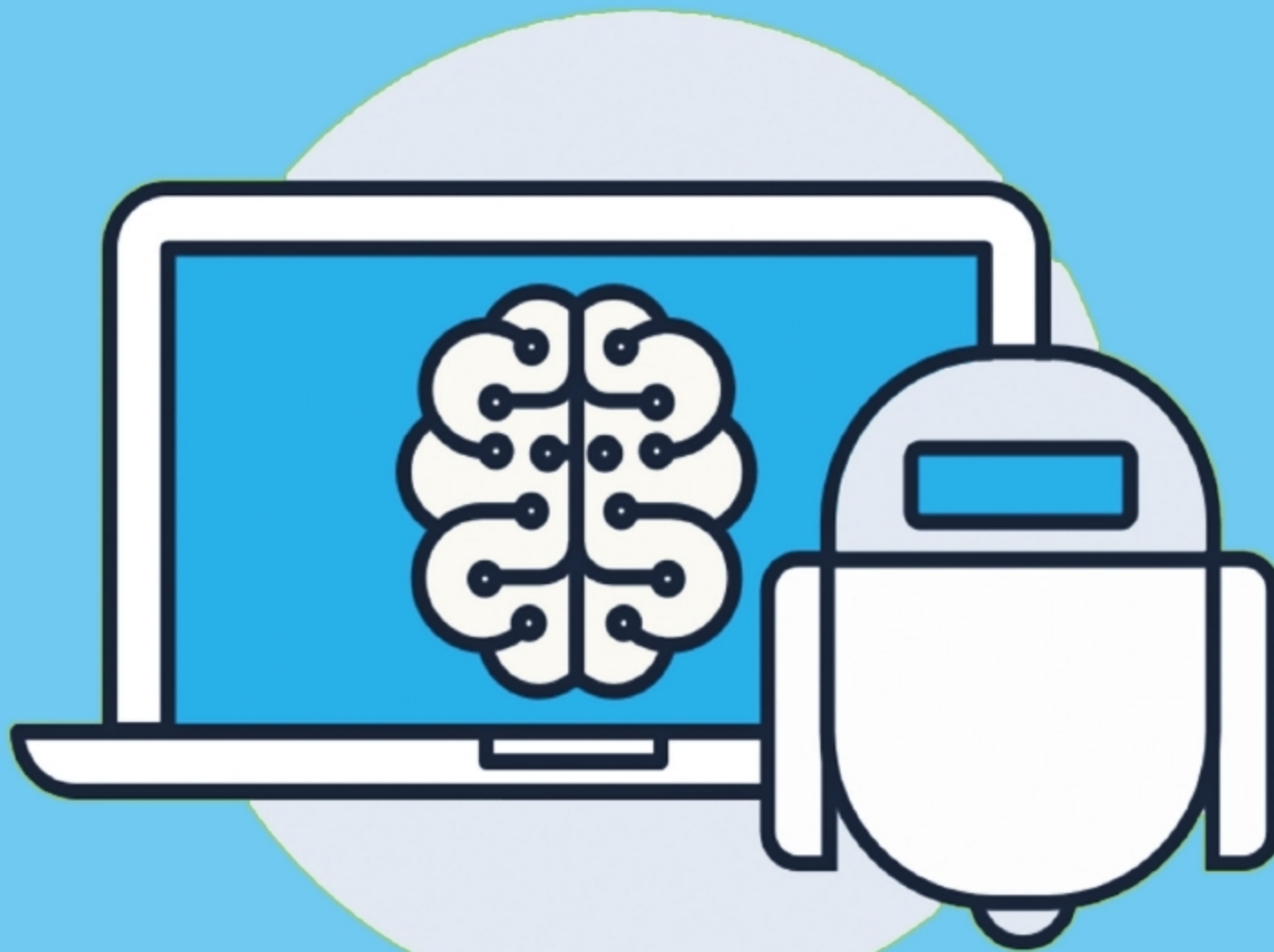


A Beginner's Guide to Machine Learning

As the title suggests, this article is for newbies who want to venture into the field of machine learning.



Machine learning (ML) is an application of artificial intelligence that provides a system the ability to learn and improve from experience without being explicitly programmed. It has become very popular because of the high volume of data produced by applications, the increase in computational power in the past few years, and the development of better algorithms.

Machine learning is used in various domains—from automating tedious tasks to offering intelligent insights, industries in every sector try to benefit from it. You may already be using a device that has ML in it—for example, a wearable fitness tracker like Fitbit, or an intelligent home assistant like Google Home.

Key terms

Machine learning terms can be confusing. Here are definitions of key terms to help you.

Data exploration is the process of gathering information about a large and often unstructured data set in order to find characteristics for focused analysis.

Data mining refers to automated data exploration.

Descriptive analytics is the process of analysing a data set in order to summarise what happened. The vast majority of business analytics—such as sales reports, Web metrics, and social networks analysis—are descriptive.

Predictive analytics is the process of building models from historical or current data in order to forecast future outcomes.